

Flightless wings

One reason birds have wings is to make a quick escape from predators. If birds don't have predators, they have no need to fly and may lose this ability over time.

Flightless birds, like this rhea, have wings that they don't use for flying.

Penguins

The penguin uses its wings as flippers to "fly" underwater. Its feathers are short and stiff to help keep them warm in cold climates.



Flightless cormorants

The Galápagos Islands off western South America have no animals that kill birds, so their cormorants have lost the ability to fly. They have become good swimmers.

Turn and learn

Penguins:
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Bird's eggs:
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Rearing rheas

Most birds' eggs are looked after by their mothers, but in the rhea family the father is in charge. He sometimes looks after up to 60 eggs, all from different mothers, in one nest.



The father looks after the babies until they are five months old.

Large flightless birds have thick legs, which help them to run fast.

Rheas and emus have three large toes that all face forwards.